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Austin, TX

Jigar Patel

Head of Platform Engineering

Platform engineer with 9+ years building and running cloud infrastructure, from 1,000-server Chef fleets to multi-cloud Kubernetes. Today I lead platform engineering at Cooklist, running the infrastructure behind agentic AI for grocery, and ship it with a team of coding agents.

90%
shorter deploy lead time

\$216K
saved per year in eng hours

200+
Kubernetes clusters patched weekly

2x
merged PRs/month with AI agents

Experience

Cooklist · Head of Platform Engineering

Dec 2025 – Present · Austin, TX

- Own the GKE platform behind agentic search and AI chat for enterprise grocery retailers across production, staging, and DR.
- Roughly doubled merged PRs per month by running coding agents in parallel worktrees behind strict merge and staging guardrails; authored 15 reusable agent skills.
- Built Chef, a hosted Hermes agent in Slack with intake, engineering, review, and knowledge roles, plus a knowledge skill that turns Slack threads and merged PRs into docs updates with decision markers.
- Built per-PR ephemeral environments with pre-seeded Postgres images, and a trunk-based release pipeline with migration gates and a guarded hotfix lane.
- Shipped an LLM-reviewed migration check that flags locking risk and recommends deploy timing on every pull request.
- Scaled AI workloads on queue backlog and custom metrics with KEDA and HPA, moved agentic search to FastAPI, and cut traffic over to a Traefik Gateway behind Cloud Armor with zero downtime.
- Lead SOC 2 readiness and enterprise security reviews: SSO with group-synced permissions, keyless CI via Workload Identity Federation, and customer security questionnaires.

Pager · Lead Platform Engineer

May 2022 – Nov 2025 · Chicago, IL

- Led a team of five platform engineers, owning SLAs, mentoring, and performance growth.
- Migrated 60 services to a modern continuous deployment platform, cutting deploy lead time 90% and saving 1,800 hours (\$216K) a year.
- Led the move from Spinnaker to Harness with canary and blue/green releases, and drove on-prem to GCP migration including containerized .NET workloads.
- Moved PostgreSQL to CloudSQL, saving \$80K+ in compute and cutting p95 latency 50% and p75 73%.
- Delivered \$113K/year in cloud savings through disk cleanup and storage right-sizing; migrated MongoDB to Atlas for 7% lower cost.
- Kept the platform HIPAA and SOC 2 compliant, and added production alerting on 14 criteria to shorten incident response.

Cerner · Senior Site Reliability Engineer

Oct 2021 – Jun 2022 · Chicago, IL

- Ran weekly patching for 200+ Kubernetes clusters across Department of Defense, Veterans Affairs, and on-prem environments.
- Wrote infrastructure as code to deploy Kubernetes on vSphere, OpenStack, AWS EC2, and EKS.

Zebra Technologies · Senior DevOps Engineer

Jul 2021 – Oct 2021 · Chicago, IL

- Rolled out Dynatrace observability across Kubernetes, compute, and a large microservices estate, wired into CI/CD for deploy tracking.

Cerner · Senior System Engineer

Oct 2019 – Jul 2021 · Kansas City, MO

- Built Kubernetes on vSphere, OpenStack, EC2, and EKS; maintained the base Helm charts and a caching proxy for client-hosted appliances.
- Provided 24/7 production support for DoD, VA, and on-prem clusters.

Cerner · System Engineer

May 2017 – Oct 2019 · Kansas City, MO

- Configured and maintained 1,000+ production RHEL and Oracle Linux servers with Chef and Jenkins, and ran vulnerability patching.

Skills

Cloud	GCP, AWS, Azure, OCI, OpenStack, vSphere
Platform	Kubernetes, Helm, KEDA, Terraform, Ansible, Chef
Delivery	GitHub Actions, Argo CD, ARC, Harness, Spinnaker
Observability	Prometheus, Datadog, Sentry, Dynatrace, k6
AI	Claude Code, Codex, MCP, Agent skills, Gemini
Languages	Python, Bash, TypeScript, Ruby, SQL

Education

Illinois Institute of Technology
B.S. Information Technology & Management
· 2014 – 2016
Harper College
A.S. Information Technology · 2012 – 2014